

Predator RF — Operator's Manual (Android App)

This manual covers the Predator RF Android application only: what works today, how to use it, and its current limits. For field procedures see `docs/OPERATOR_RUNBOOK.md` ; for pre-departure checks see `docs/MISSION_READY_CHECKLIST.md` .

1. Quick Start

1. **Connect an SDR** (or a remote node — see §9). Select the source in the **SYS** tab and press Play.
 2. Pick a **mission mode** in the MIS tray: MANUAL, SCAN, QUICKSCAN, or CLASSIFY.
 3. Configure **Search Bands**, **Targets**, and **Exclude Bands** in MIS.
 4. Watch the spectrum. Double-tap to place markers (Manual/Classify); Scan/Classify place them automatically on strong hits.
 5. Review detections in **HITS**; hold interesting frequencies for persistent monitoring/decoding.
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2. Screen Layout & Tabs (right rail)

Tab	Purpose
SPEC	Main FFT + waterfall. Display controls, band plan, mission status, A1/A2 arrow readouts.
HITS	All detections: Quick Filter (All/Target/Exclude/Unknown), Held Frequencies (decoders), Marker Pool, Detected Hits list, Events log.
NET	Peer node list + network topology view.
MAP	Tactical map: own GPS position, peer positions, DF lines of bearing.
MIS	Mission config: search bands, targets, excludes, scan dwell/threshold. Opens as a left slide-out tray.
KUJ	Kujhad fleet: drive a remote peer's radio, mirror its spectrum and mission.
SYS	SDR source/device, audio sinks, appearance, global settings.
BASE	RF baseline recorder + baseline comparison filter.
TX	Fox Hunt transmit controls. Only appears in the Fox Hunt mission.

Status banner colors: green = local radio, amber = driving a peer, red = peer link stale. GPS shows `GPS READY` / `GPS WAIT` .

3. Mission Modes

- **MANUAL** — you tune, you place markers. Nothing automated.

- **SCAN** — steps across every enabled search band, dwelling per step and logging hits above the SNR threshold. Markers auto-assign from the pool.
- **QUICKSCAN** — rapid single-marker sweep for a fast look.
- **CLASSIFY** — you keep manual control of tuning while the app watches the visible band and auto-places markers on detections (toggleable).

4. Spectrum Gestures

Gesture	Action
One-finger drag	Pan / tune
Pinch	Zoom frequency span
Double-tap	Place a marker at that frequency (Manual/Classify)
Long-press on a marker	Marker menu: Name..., Target, Exclude, Adjust, Remove Marker
Long-press on empty spectrum	Recenter/tune there
Drag FFT/waterfall divider (short hold)	Resize FFT vs waterfall

Adjust: after choosing Adjust from the marker menu, drag left/right to fine-place the marker; lift to commit.

5. Markers & Hits

- Marker pool size is configurable (1–16 slots, "Marker Slots" setting); slots are labelled M1, M2, A marker pins a frequency, draws a labelled vertical line on FFT + waterfall, and (in Manual/Classify) opens a lightweight channel usable for per-marker IQ recording.
 - **Color legend:**
 - **Yellow** — ordinary hit / unknown signal.
 - **Green** — matches a configured Target.
 - **Red wash** — Exclude zone (hits suppressed there).
 - **Cyan, dashed** — a peer's markers mirrored over the network.
 - Hits cluster by frequency; each row tracks hit count, max RSSI, and state. Row actions: hold (+ Hold), marker assign/release, gear menu for recording options, Target/Exclude promotion.
 - **Events log** (HITS tab): automated threshold hits, manual "Log Event" entries, and decoder output (IDs, talkgroups, sensor data).
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6. Held Frequencies & Decoders

- **+ Hold** on a hit creates a persistent held entry (survives restarts, up to 8 concurrent).
- Decoder kinds selectable per hold: Analog voice (AM/NBFM/WBFM/SSB), DSD-FME digital voice, ADS-B, RTL-433.

- **Auto-decode today:** only **RTL-433** spawns automatically from a hold. DSD-FME (P25), ADS-B, and the analog radio kinds are manual-load for now (multi-P25 concurrent decode is on the roadmap).
 - DSD-FME is single-instance: one digital-voice decode at a time.
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7. Recording

- **Per-marker raw IQ:** gear icon on a hit row → "Record raw IQ (.wav)"; files land in auto-created subfolders. Alternatively use the SDR++ Recorder module in Baseband mode and select the marker's `Predator M#` channel.
 - **Decoded product:** gear icon → save decoded voice/data per hold.
 - **Global recorder:** SYS/sinks menu for whole-session audio or baseband.
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8. Baseline (BASE tab)

- **Record** a baseline while moving through an area to profile its ambient RF.
 - Enable **Baseline Comparison** so Scan/Classify only report signals that exceed the recorded environment by your threshold — new emitters stand out, static noise disappears.
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9. Networking & Peer Control

Kujhad fleet (KUJ tab)

- Any node can run a **Device Server** (toggle in KUJ) so peers can view or drive it; QR codes speed up pairing. Auth via shared key, optional TLS with certificate pinning.
- As **Controller** you mirror a peer's spectrum, markers, and decoders live, and can task tune/scan/mission changes. Banner turns amber while driving a peer, red if the link goes stale.
- **RX-only posture:** remote transmit commands are hard-rejected at every network surface. Nothing on the network can key a transmitter (see Fox Hunt exception below — separate opt-in class, still not `tx.*`).

Remote cockpit (phone as console)

- The `Predator Node` source turns the app into a pure console for a remote Pi/PC node over hotspot/Wi-Fi — full native UI, no local SDR needed. Common link addresses are auto-probed.

Off-grid & TAK

- **Reticulum (RNS):** CoT and command tasking over low-bandwidth/IP-denied links (identity-hash authenticated).
- **ATAK/TAK CoT:** operator-initiated export; UDP multicast push plus an HTTP pull endpoint for when multicast is blocked. Kraken bearings render as wedges in TAK.

Multi-node sensing

- **Custody election:** the fleet auto-nominates the best-placed node to own an emitter (SNR, GPS health, geometry).
 - **TDOA (Controller mode):** geolocates emitters from peer time-difference measurements; nodes without disciplined clocks are confidence-capped.
 - **KrakenSDR:** 5-channel DF lines of bearing, one-tap retasking from the hits list or map, triangulated fixes on the MAP tab.
 - **Correlation engine:** flags when multiple nodes hear the same band and cues geolocation on fingerprint matches.
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10. Fox Hunt (TX tab)

- Local-hardware-only transmit for training/fox-hunt exercises: IQ file replay, steady tone, or CW beacon (callsign + WPM configurable), manual / marker-derived / sweep frequency modes.
 - **Remote Fox Hunt** tasking exists but each node must explicitly tick "Accept Remote Fox Hunt tasking" — off by default, dead-man timer stops the beacon if the controller goes silent.
 - Know your license and local regulations before transmitting. CW beacons should carry your callsign.
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11. Arrow Markers (A1/A2)

Toggle A1/A2 above the spectrum, tap to drop. Each shows a precise frequency readout; with both placed you get a Δ -frequency measurement — handy for channel spacing and offset checks. They're display-only and never affect the radio.

12. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Meaning / fix
STALLED badge	Sample flow stopped. Check the SDR connection/USB; if it persists, restart the source from SYS. (Marker-induced stalls were fixed — update your build if you still see stall-on-marker.)
GPS WAIT	No fix yet — check location permission and sky view. Map/DF features need a fix.
Red banner	Peer link stale — check the network path to the node; control is suspended until it recovers.
Marker won't place	Double-tap placement works in Manual/Classify. In Scan, markers auto-assign from hits.
No decode from a hold	Only RTL-433 auto-spawns today; other decoders must be loaded manually (§6).
Keyboard covers a field	All editable fields use the pop-up editor above the keyboard; if one doesn't, report it — that's a bug.

13. Current Limits (honest list)

- One DSD-FME (digital voice) decode at a time; multi-P25 is roadmap.
- Hold auto-decode wired for RTL-433 only.
- TDOA on-device UI is Controller-mode; timing-poor nodes are confidence-capped.
- The app is RX-only over the network by design; all remote TX except the opt-in Fox Hunt beacon class is rejected.